



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2019/2020

FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF
BACHELOR OF EDUCATION AND BACHELOR OF ARTS

AEN 200: INTRODUCTION TO PHONETICS & PHONOLOGY

DATE: Friday, 13th December 2019

TIME: 8.00a.m-10.00p.m

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer question 1 and any other two

1) Use the data below drawn from hypothetical language X to answer the questions that follow:

2)

- | | |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| a) [gutaka] "to scream" | b) [kipik] "to run" |
| c) [eβende] "bone" | d) [lapá] "courtyard" |
| e) [leket] "mountain" | f) [rerútá] "we teach" |
| g) [á rúte] "he should praise" | h) [amaka] "bird" |
| i) [amakog] "line" | j) [amarok] "fly" |
| k) [bóna] "to see" | l) [guta:ka] "to decorate" |
| m) [kipig] "horse" | n) [lapa] "become tired" |
| o) [eyende] let it go | p) [réru'tá] "while we teach" |
| q) [monem] "angel" | r) [a rúte] "he praises habitually" |
| r) [boná] "they" | s) [kipit] "hole" |
| t) [adua] "village" | u) [adie] "spinister" |

- (a) Identify at least ten minimal pairs in the data set above (10marks)
- (b) Highlight the phonemes in the minimal pairs you have identified in (a) above (5marks)
- (c) In addition to minimal pair tests, linguistics also use complementary distribution and free variation to identify phonemes in a language. Citing examples to illustrate your answers, describe what you understand by free variation and complementary distribution (6 marks)
- (d) Based on the parameters of consonant and vowel production explain how the following are produced: (9 marks)
- (i) Consonants-/s/
 - (ii) Approximants-/j/

2.(a) Briefly explain the difference between phones, phonemes and allophones and give an example of each (6marks)

(b) Describe the following sounds according to the specifications given (10marks)

- (i) [e] Horizontal and vertical position of the tongue
- (ii) [p'] Place of articulation and airstream mechanism
- (iii) [r] Stricture type
- (iv) [n] State of the glottis
- (v) [e] Shape of the lips
- (vi) (b) manner of articulation and phonation
- (vii) [w] Place of articulation

(c) Draw the syllable structure of the following words (4marks)

- (i) I
- (ii) Fire

3. (a) Explain the difference between broad and narrow transcription and give an example of each to illustrate your answers. (8marks)

(b) With the aid of examples from any language explain the major differences between vowels and consonants (8 marks)

(c) Briefly discuss any two types of airstream mechanisms involved in the production of sounds in the human vocal tract. (4marks)

4. Describe any 5 secondary articulation processes that may be found in world languages. Give examples from any language, other than English. To illustrate your answer. (20marks)

5. (a) Describe the following vowels based on four parameters of vowel production/description (10mark)

- (i) /u:/
- (ii) /ʌ/
- (iii) /ɪ/
- (iv) /o/
- (v) /ae/

(b) Explain the role of the following articulators

- (i) Speech production
- (ii) Glottis
- (iii) Velum

SIR OTONDE MICHAEL



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY
UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2012/2013
MAY SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF
EDUCATION (ARTS)

AEN 200: INTRODUCTION TO PHONETICS AND PHONOLOGY

DATE: FRIDAY, 2ND AUGUST 2013

TIME: 4.30 P.M. – 6.30 P.M.

Instructions: **Answer all questions in section A and one question in each of sections B and C.**

SECTION A

1.

A) Study the following words.

gait	mate
fate	write
site	might
fight	hate
rate	gate
height	said

- i. Explain what is mean by a Minimal Pair in phonology. (2 marks)
- ii. Arrange these words so as to form four sets of minimal pairs. (8 marks)
- iii. The sets of minimal pairs identified in 'ii' above can be used to identify two vowel phonemes and four consonant phonemes. Identify all these phonemes. (6 marks)
- iv. The remaining four words share some phonetic characteristics but cannot constitute minimal pairs. Explain. (4 marks)

B) (a) Give a phonetic transcription of the following words. (3 marks)

- i. deep
- ii. peek
- iii. speed

(b) Use the words in '(a)' above to explain the concept of Complementary Distribution in phonological analysis. (7 marks)

SECTION B

2. a) Highlight the relationship between phonetics and phonology. (6 marks)
- b) Giving two examples in each case, explain seven ways of classifying consonant sounds using the criterion of the manner of articulation. (14 marks)

3. a) Give a description of the following sounds. (4 marks)

- i. [ʃ]
- ii. [g]
- iii. [ʒ]
- iv. [ə]

b) Write the phonemic transcription of the following words. (10 marks)

- i) university
- ii) meat
- iii) life
- iv) shut
- v) thief

c) Using two examples for each, distinguish between active and passive articulators. (6 marks)

SECTION C

4. With illustrating examples, discuss the following concepts as they are used in phonetics. (20 marks)

- i. Phonation
- ii. Airstream mechanism
- iii. Secondary articulation

5. Using appropriate examples, explain the role of the following suprasegmental features in language. (20 marks)

- i. Stress
- ii. intonation



KENYATTA UNIVERSITY

UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2015/2016

SECOND SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF EDUCATION AND BACHELOR ARTS

AEN 200: INTRODUCTION TO PHONETICS AND PHONOLOGY

DATE: Wednesday, 6th April 2016

TIME: 2.00 p.m. - 4.00p.m.

INSTRUCTIONS:

Answer question 1 and any other Two.

- 1.a) i) In your opinion, can Phonetics be studies without Phonology? (5 Marks)
- ii) What is the level of relationship between Phonetics and Phonology? (5 Marks)
- iii) Phonetics is general while Phonology is specific. Disuss these claims with corpus of data. (5 Marks)
- b) i) Briefly state how you would trace the journey of any given sound from the time it leaves the lungs to the time it is produced. Specify the language. (15 Marks)
2. Select any 5 vowels and any 5 consonants of English and attempt a formal description of them. (20 Marks)
3. Classify all the consonants of English using the criteria learnt in class. (20 Marks)
- i) Circle the sounds that are produced with nasal airflow:
- l g w v m ʃ ŋ (1 Mark)

ii) Circle the labial sounds:

(1 Mark)

v n dʒ ɹ^w u w

iii) Circle the sounds in which the passive articulator is the uvular:

(1 Mark)

k χ n u

iii) Circle the sounds that are produced with complete closure at the alveolar ridge:

(1mark)

s d r t^h ʒ ʙ w n

iv) Provide phonetic names for the feature classes Laryngeal, Airstream, Place, nasality, Stricture for the speech sounds listed below:

i. m

ii. z^j

iii. d

iv. g

v. ʙ

vi. ʒ

(2 marks)

v) Give phonetic notation for the following speech sounds:

i. breathy alveolar lateral approximant

ii. voiced retroflex oral stop

iii. voiceless lateral fricative

4. The following can be used to discover speech sounds in phonetics. Explain the concepts and illustrate how they can be used to do this. (20 Marks)

i) Free variation.

ii) Minimal pairs

iii) Complementary distribution.

5. a) The placement of stress can distinguish meaning in some words.
Illustrate this fact using two such words in sentences. (4 Marks)
- b) Giving appropriate examples, distinguish tone from intonation. (4 Marks)
- c) Describe the three main branches of phonetics. (12 Marks)



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UNIVERSITY EXAMINATIONS 2017/2018
FIRST SEMESTER EXAMINATION FOR THE DEGREE OF BACHELOR OF
EDUCATION AND BACHELOR OF ARTS
AEN 200: INTRODUCTION TO PHONETICS & PHONOLOGY

DATE: TUESDAY 28TH NOVEMBER 2017

TIME: 2.00 P.M. - 4.00 P.M.

INSTRUCTIONS:

QUESTION ONE (COMPULSORY)

Use the data provided below to answer all the questions that follow

PHONETIC TRANSCRIPTIONS

- | | |
|--------------|----------|
| 1. / bəʊt / | / gəʊt / |
| 2. / tɔ:t / | / θɔ:t / |
| 3. / sɪk / | / sɪŋ / |
| 4. / naʊ / | / kaʊ / |
| 5. / tʃeə / | / peə / |
| 6. / fi:t / | / bi:t / |
| 7. / rɪd / | / kɪd / |
| 8. / dʒʌdʒ / | / bʌdʒ / |
| 9. / tɔ:tʃ / | / tɔ:k / |
| 10. / ti:m / | / ti:n / |

- a) Give the orthographic representation of each of the phonetic transcriptions above. (10 marks)
- b) Use the data to explain the term minimal pairs (4 marks)
- c) identify and describe all the fricatives in the data (6 marks)
- d) Separately plot all the monophthongs and diphthongs in a vowel trapezium (10 marks)

Question Two

Briefly explain the concerns of Acoustic, Auditory, and Articulatory phonetics. (20 marks)

Question Three

- a) Discuss the role of airstream mechanisms in phonetic analysis. (15 marks)
- b) Discuss the concept of phonation, using suitable illustrations. (5 marks)

Question Four

- a) Give a phonetic description of each of the following sounds.
 - i) |k|
 - ii) |ʃ|
 - ii) |h|
 - iv) |b|
 - v) |θ|

(10 marks)
- b) Describe the vocal track and the role it plays in the production of speech sound. Illustrate your answer with a clearly labeled diagram (10 marks)

Question Five

Using suitable examples, discuss four types of secondary articulation. (20 marks)
